Marco | Family review checklist

Reviewer: _____ Date: _____

Question 1: Your role in Marco's education

What do you see as your main role in your child's education?

For each recommendation, check Agree or Do not agree. Leave both blank if undecided. Add a note where you would prefer different wording or need to confirm a fact.

1.1 Replace the exam-day answer-checking account

Use a preparation or practice example instead. The account of a parent sitting beside Marco with practice tests during the actual theory exam could raise a concern about assistance. The PDF does not establish what help was permitted.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

1.2 Confirm who checked the exam answers

The earlier black draft describes a parent finding and communicating answers; the purple draft attributes verification to Marco. Confirm what happened and the exam rules. This is a factual question that editing alone cannot resolve.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

1.3 Keep the warmth of the piano recording story

Keep the reassurance that Mom will be there when he is ready. Shorten the lighting, equipment, repeated takes, and score details so parental patience remains the focus.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

1.4 Show how support builds independence

Explain how your help leaves Marco responsible for his own work. Repeated references to staying beside him, extensive exam involvement, and half-day study sessions can overshadow his independence.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

1.5 Keep curiosity examples concise

Preserve the shared reading and conversations that show your family's interest in learning. Reduce extra lesson details and awards so this answer stays focused on your role as parents.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

1.6 Fix the sentence fragment

Change "His longest piece being about four minutes" to "His longest piece was about four minutes." This is a straightforward copyedit the final draft needs.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

Comments / preferred wording

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Question 2: Why Sage Hill

Explain your interest in sending your child to Sage Hill.

For each recommendation, check Agree or Do not agree. Leave both blank if undecided. Add a note where you would prefer different wording or need to confirm a fact.

2.1 Open with Marco's interests and possibilities

Replace the emphasis on being "not a strongly STEM-driven student" and on community pressure. His turtle project already combines art, technology, collaboration, and business; leave room for him to explore.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

2.2 Consider this opening direction

"Marco is happiest when he is creating something - writing and illustrating comics, designing turtles with a friend, or making a handmade gift. We are drawn to Sage Hill's opportunities to develop those interests while continuing to explore new ones."

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

2.3 Connect interests to confirmed middle school offerings

Visual art, digital art, journalism, and debate are listed in Sage Hill's middle school FAQ. Confirm availability for his entry year. Verify business and entrepreneurship access before making them a central reason for choosing the school.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

2.4 Shorten the colleagues-and-children paragraph

Reduce the list of colleagues' names and their children's grades to one sentence about recommendations from families you trust. Use the space for your own observations and Marco's connection to the school.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

2.5 Develop the summer-camp recognition detail

Keep the meaningful observation that a staff member remembered Marco from camp. It supports the family's impression of a welcoming school where teachers know students personally.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

2.6 Keep the cafeteria comment brief

If retained, let it be one short, charming line in Marco's own voice. Give more space to the educational reasons and the family's firsthand experience.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

2.7 Polish the tone and awkward phrasing

Remove "Among all of this hype" and replace "answering most affectionately" with natural wording such as "answered warmly." Change "a school as Sage Hill" to "a school like Sage Hill."

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

School offerings source: sagehillschool.org/admission/middle-school (reviewed October 26, 2026)

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Question 3: Parent volunteering and community involvement

As the parent(s), please describe any volunteer work, service activities, or community involvement you have participated in.

For each recommendation, check Agree or Do not agree. Leave both blank if undecided. Add a note where you would prefer different wording or need to confirm a fact.

3.1 Keep the concrete service examples

Helping at the Jog-A-Thon and judging speech and debate are credible examples. Center the answer on what each parent contributes.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

3.2 Shorten the description of the debate students

The discussion of how impressive the students are takes space away from Marco's father's contribution. Focus on judging responsibilities, time given, and useful feedback.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

3.3 Add accurate frequency or duration

If known, include how many years you have helped, how often his father judges, and what those responsibilities involve. Do not add estimates that you cannot confirm.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

3.4 Keep the November service activity's tense accurate

It is currently described as planned. If the application is submitted after the activity, update the answer with what the family actually did. Shorten the broad promise to "spread love and joy to those who are suffering."

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

3.5 Remove the duplicated opening words

The sentence "Every year, at Marco's school Jog-A-Thon every year I volunteer" repeats "every year." A clearer version is: "I volunteer at Marco's school Jog-A-Thon each year."

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

Comments / preferred wording

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Question 4: Academic and personal strengths and weaknesses

Describe your child's academic and personal strengths and weaknesses.

For each recommendation, check Agree or Do not agree. Leave both blank if undecided. Add a note where you would prefer different wording or need to confirm a fact.

4.1 Shorten and organize the answer

The purple response is approximately 876 words and covers many activities. Reduce the number of examples and help the reader understand which qualities matter most.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

4.2 Build around three main qualities

Use creative initiative (comics and one recent project), academic independence (APAAS work and a specific example), and care for others (the handmade frog). These create a clear picture of Marco.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

4.3 Keep taekwondo as a shorter persistence example

Preserve the accomplishment and his willingness to compete independently. Reduce comparisons with children who quit or had coaches, and avoid describing black belt as "the greatest honor."

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

4.4 Verify the taekwondo event name and category

Check the 2025 competition's official name and category against his certificate. The brainstorming notes and final wording describe the event differently. Use a general description until confirmed.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

4.5 Resolve the turtle-business story accurately

"The principal ... unfortunately put a stop to it" can sound dismissive and leaves the ending unresolved. If retained, explain accurately why sales ended and how Marco responded. Include a lesson learned only if it actually happened.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

4.6 Keep the weakness honest and show progress

Preserve perfectionism as a real growth area. Explain what frustration looks like, what helps, and the improvement you have seen, including taking breaks and returning to a difficult task.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

4.7 Remove absolute claims

Avoid statements such as "always finishes whatever he starts" and "never angry towards other people." Use measured wording that a parent can confidently support.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

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Question 5: Additional information

Is there any additional information that you would like to provide to the Admission Committee?

For each recommendation, check Agree or Do not agree. Leave both blank if undecided. Add a note where you would prefer different wording or need to confirm a fact.

5.1 Preserve the grandparents story

His choice to spend all fourteen nights with his grandparents, and his wish to call and share news with them, reveal affection and connection beyond grades and activities.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

5.2 Shorten the sibling argument scene

Keep Marco's care for Harry and his awareness of being a role model. Reduce the details about everyone yelling or fighting so the relationship remains the focus.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

5.3 Consider cutting the teacher-and-candy anecdote

It adds less than the grandparents story or handmade frog. Removing it would make this answer shorter and give the strongest family example more room.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

5.4 Let the examples carry the conclusion

Remove the claim that his kindness cannot be expressed in words and the promise that he will bring only kindness, happiness, and joy. A simple ending about how he shows care is more convincing.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

Comments / preferred wording

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Whole application: Overall decisions

These are decisions about the whole set of parent statements, not a sixth application question.

For each recommendation, check Agree or Do not agree. Leave both blank if undecided. Add a note where you would prefer different wording or need to confirm a fact.

6.1 Ask the counselor for another substantial revision

Marco comes across as creative, affectionate, funny, and self-motivated. The family stories are strong, but selection, framing, factual precision, and proofreading need another pass before submission.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

6.2 Protect the most memorable details

Keep the strongest examples: Marshmallow and Onion, the handmade frog, his turtle designs, and his relationship with his grandparents. Choose their placement so they add something distinct in each answer.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

6.3 Preserve a natural parent voice

Retain the counselor's useful wording and your family's observations. Some purple revisions are less natural than the earlier version; simplify formal phrasing and repeated praise.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

6.4 Check every fact and the portal limits

Confirm the accuracy of every statement and check the application's actual word or character limits. No limits were provided in the source PDF. Make each answer serve a distinct purpose.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

6.5 Request a final copyedit

Catch repeated words, fragments, awkward expressions, and inconsistent details throughout. A counselor's final version should already have had this check.

☐ Agree ☐ Do not agree Note: _____

Comments / preferred wording